

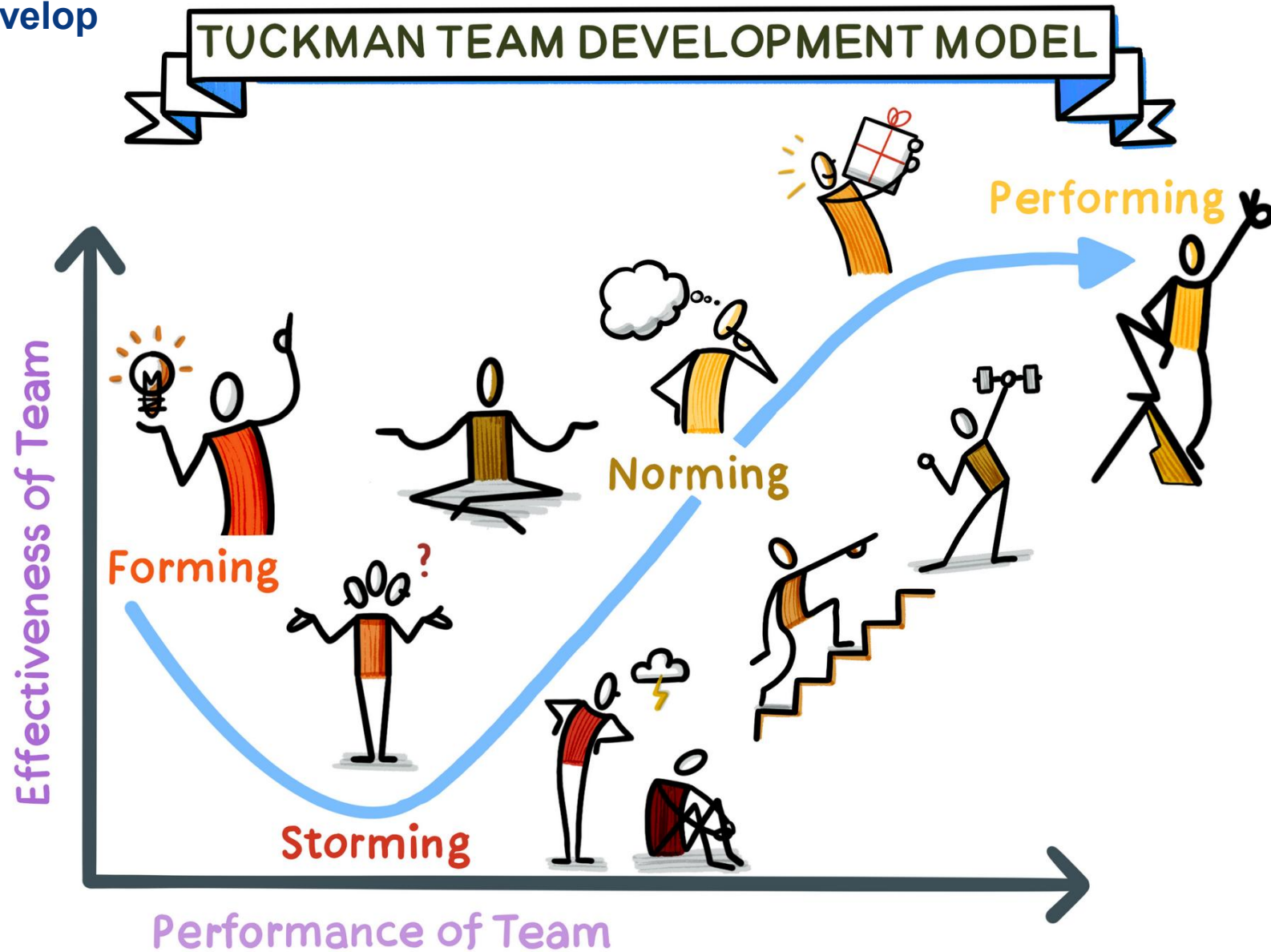


Prof. Dr.-Ing. Lamyia Abdullah Lamyia.Abdullah@provadis-hochschule.de

Interkulturelle Kommunikation und heterogene Teams

Lecture Notes- 04: Teams 2.0 and Organization

From *understanding culture* → *working with real teams effectively*



<https://www.thevisualfacilitator.co.uk/blog/tuckmans-model-of-team-development>

Leader Actions

- Forming → **Structure & direction**
- Storming → **Conflict** management
- Norming → **Trust** building
- Performing → **Autonomy**
- Adjourning → **Reflection**

Teams fail when leaders
treat all stages the same

A low-angle, blue-tinted photograph of a group of graduates in academic regalia. They are all looking upwards with expressions of joy and excitement, and several black graduation caps are captured mid-air, having just been tossed. The scene is bright and celebratory.

Team Structure : What Makes Teams Work

Team Effectiveness

GRPI Model

The GRPI model focuses on 4 key components:



Goals



Roles



Processes



Interpersonal
relationships.

<https://joiningenius.com/productivity/team-effectiveness-models/>

GPRI Model – for team effectiveness

What is our **purpose**?
Are we **aligned**?

Who is doing **what**?
Are **responsibilities**
overlapping or missing?



How we work?

How **well** do we **communicate**?
Is there **trust** and **openness**?

GPRI Model – for team effectiveness

It's often used to:

- **Diagnose issues** in underperforming teams
- **Start new teams** on a solid foundation
- **Resolve team conflicts** by identifying root causes



If goals are **unclear**, roles are likely **confused**,
which leads to **chaotic** processes and interpersonal **friction**.

Other models for Teams effectiveness

A Good Read

“11 Team Effectiveness Models To Build Your A-Player Team”, 2025.

<https://joiningenius.com/productivity/team-effectiveness-models/>

Robbins & Judge Model

The Robbins & Judge Model emphasizes 4 dimensions:



Context



Composition



Work design



Process

T7 Model

The T7 model identifies 5 internal factors and 2 external factors:



Thrust



Trust



Talent



Teaming skills



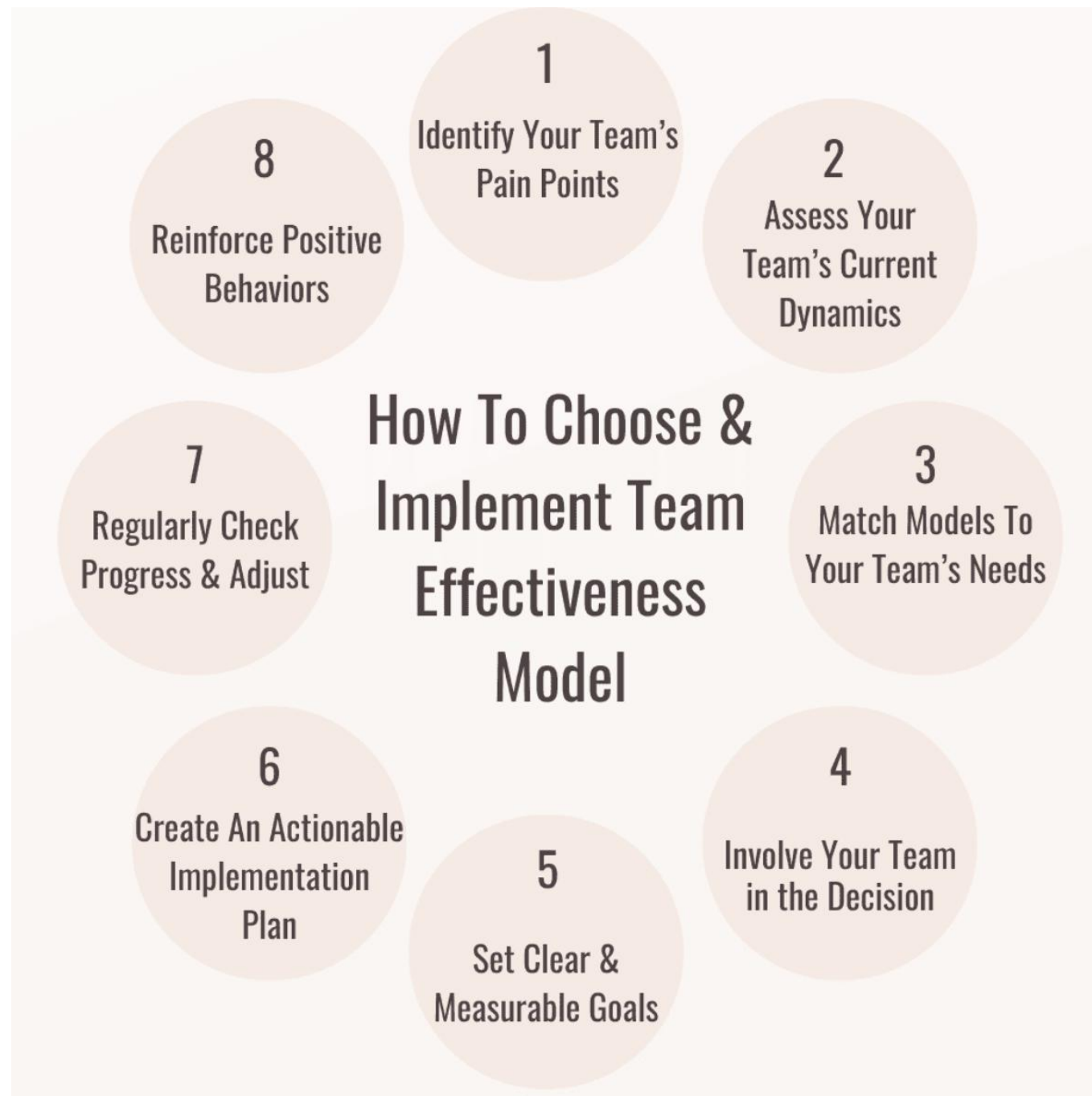
Task skills



Team leader fit



Talent Support



For completeness

- **SMART** goals,
- **RACI, RASI**

Team Effectiveness Tools/Models/ Methods

People Collaboration

What Does **SMART** goal Stand For?

Each letter represents a key characteristic of a **well-defined** goal:



tools used in project management and teamwork to clarify roles and responsibilities



<https://www.linkedin.com/pulse/defining-roles-rasci-joaquim-torres-joca/>

Letter	Role	What It Means
R	Responsible	Person(s) doing the work to complete the task
A	Accountable	Person ultimately answerable for the task; has final decision authority
C	Consulted	Person(s) who must be consulted before action or decision is made (two-way input)
I	Informed	Person(s) who must be kept informed after decisions or actions are made (one-way)

Example: Publishing a Blog Post

Task	R (Does)	A (Owns)	C (Input)	I (Updated)
Write the article	Content writer	Editor	Subject expert	Marketing manager
Approve for publishing	Editor	Editor	Legal advisor	Team

Letter	Role	What It Means
R	Responsible	Person(s) doing the work
A	Accountable	Person ultimately accountable
S	Support	Person(s) who help or provide resources to complete the task
I	Informed	Person(s) who are updated or notified

Example: Launching a Product Feature

Task	R	A	S	I
Develop new feature	Developer	Tech lead	QA tester, Designer	Project manager

Use **RACI** when **decision-making** and **stakeholder communication** are **key**.

Use **RASI** when you want to **highlight support roles** (like helpers, assistants, technical aid).

A low-angle, blue-tinted photograph of a diverse group of graduates in black gowns, cheering and throwing their caps into the air. The scene is filled with joy and accomplishment, with several caps captured mid-air against a bright, overexposed background.

Team Roles (Belbin)

Why Diversity Matters

Team Roles (Belbin Roles)

Teams work **better** when people take **different roles**

A team is **not** just made of **individuals**, it is a **combination** of **different roles** that **contribute** to **success**.

Examples

- **Coordinator** → organizes
- **Implementer** → executes
- **Plant** → creative thinker
- **Teamworker** → supports others



<https://www.sabrehq.com/post/the-belbin-team-role-model-the-key-to-genuine-team-building>

Team Roles (Belbin Roles), cont.

Belbin identified that:

- People tend to **behave** in **specific role patterns** in teams
- **Effective** teams require a **balance of different roles**
- **No single** person can **cover all** roles effectively



<https://www.sabrehq.com/post/the-belbin-team-role-model-the-key-to-genuine-team-building>

Belbin Roles: Categories of Roles

1. Thinking Roles (Idea-oriented) 🧠

Focus: Ideas, analysis, problem solving

- **Plant**
→ Creative, generates innovative ideas
Risk: May ignore details
- **Monitor Evaluator**
→ Logical, analytical, evaluates options
Risk: May appear critical or slow
- **Specialist**
→ Deep expert knowledge in a specific area
Risk: May focus **too** narrowly



<https://www.sabrehq.com/post/the-belbin-team-role-model-the-key-to-genuine-team-building>

Belbin Roles: Categories of Roles

2. Action Roles (Task-oriented) ⚙️

Focus: Execution, results, getting things done

- **Implementer**
→ Turns ideas into practical actions
Risk: Can resist new ideas
- **Shaper**
→ Drives the team forward, challenges others
Risk: Can be aggressive or confrontational
- **Completer Finisher**
→ Ensures quality, checks details, meets deadlines
Risk: Can be perfectionist / overfocused on errors



<https://www.sabrehq.com/post/the-belbin-team-role-model-the-key-to-genuine-team-building>

Belbin Roles: Categories of Roles

3. Social Roles (People-oriented) 🤝

Focus: Relationships, teamwork, coordination

- **Coordinator**

→ Organises, delegates, keeps overview

Risk: May delegate too much

- **Teamworker**

→ Supports others, builds harmony

Risk: Avoids conflict

- **Resource Investigator**

→ Explores opportunities, networks externally

Risk: May lose interest quickly



<https://www.sabrehq.com/post/the-belbin-team-role-model-the-key-to-genuine-team-building>

Team problems are often caused by:

- **imbalance** of roles
- **misunderstanding** of **contributions**

NOT by:

- lack of **intelligence**
- lack of **effort**

High-performing teams have a **balance of all three categories**

Teams struggle when:

- **too** many people play the **same** role
- **key roles** are missing

Which roles are **most important** in a **startup**?

Which roles are **most** important in a **structured organisation**?

A low-angle, blue-tinted photograph of a group of graduates in black gowns, cheering and throwing their caps into the air. The scene is filled with joy and celebration, with several caps captured mid-air against a bright background.

Belbin Role Exercise :
Self-awareness + Importance of role balance

What Role Do You Play in a Team?



Individual [10-15 min]

Think about your behaviour in team projects:

- How do you **usually** act?
- What do you **naturally** contribute?
- Choose Your **Dominant** Role (from the model)
[Support with Example]

Group Work [15-20 min]

- What roles do you have? **Best** for ?
- Which roles are **missing**?

Prepare for Discussion

- Do you have **too many similar** roles?
- What **problems** could arise?
- What would your team **struggle** with?

Thinking / Idea roles

Plant → “I create new ideas”

Monitor Evaluator → “I analyse and evaluate”

Specialist → “I provide expert knowledge”

Action / Task roles

Implementer → “I get things done”

Shaper → “I push the team forward”

Completer Finisher → “I focus on details and quality”

Social / People roles

Coordinator → “I organise and lead”

Teamworker → “I support harmony”

Resource Investigator → “I explore opportunities”

Focus on **real behaviour**, not ideal answers

There is **NO** “best” role or team composition

- Too many **idea** roles → **no execution**
- Too many **action** roles → **low creativity**
- Too many **people** roles → **slow decisions**

Effectiveness depends on:

- **context** (startup vs organisation)
- **goals** (innovation vs efficiency)

A blue-tinted photograph of graduates in gowns and caps, celebrating with their arms raised and caps tossed into the air. The image serves as a background for the slide.

Teams Cohesion vs Performance

What Really Matters?

What is Cohesion?

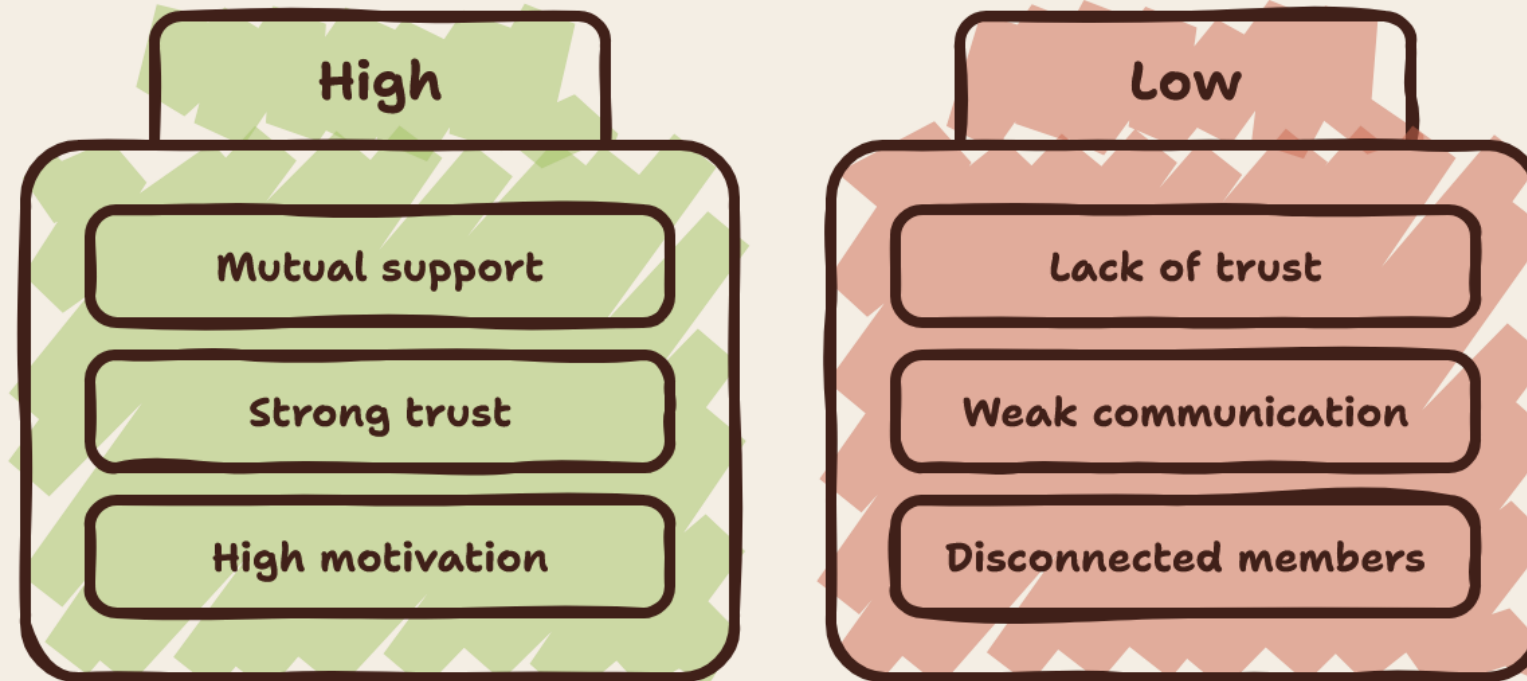
- **Cohesion** is The **strength** of **relationships** and **bonds** within a team

It describes:

- How much people **like each other**
- How strong the **sense of belonging** is
- How willing members are to **stay in the team**



Team cohesion



Can a team be **very** friendly but still **fail**?

Have you **ever been** in such a **team**?

What are they?

Shared **expectations** about:

- **effort**
- **quality**
- **behaviour**

Cohesion alone does **NOT** automatically lead to high performance

	High Cohesion	Low Cohesion
High Performance Norms	High Productivity	Moderate Productivity
Low Performance Norms	Low Productivity	Moderate to Low Productivity

Teams Cohesion vs Performance Norms → Productivity

	High Cohesion	Low Cohesion
High Performance Norms	High Productivity	Moderate Productivity
Low Performance Norms	Low Productivity	Moderate to Low Productivity

The matrix in details

1. High cohesion + strong norms [Best case]

- Team **likes** each other
- Team **expects** high performance

→ Result: **High productivity**

2. High cohesion + low norms

“Nice but ineffective team”

- Friendly environment
- Low expectations

→ Result: **Low performance**

3. Low cohesion + strong norms

“Cold but effective team”

- People don't connect well
- But performance expectations are clear

→ Result: **Medium performance**

4. Low cohesion + low norms [Worst case]

- No trust
- No expectations

→ Result: **Very low performance**

Final Remarks!

Link this to the models

- **Belbin** → **roles** influence **cohesion**
- **GRPI** → performance **norms** part of **processes/goals**

Remember:

Cohesion **improves** performance **only** when combined with **clear performance expectations**.

A low-angle, blue-tinted photograph of a group of graduates in academic regalia. They are all looking upwards with expressions of joy and excitement, and several of them have thrown their black graduation caps into the air. The caps are captured in various stages of flight, creating a sense of dynamic movement. The background is a bright, clear sky.

High-Performing Teams

What Makes a Team High-Performing?

Key Factors/ Characteristics :

- **Clear** goals
- **Defined** roles
- **Trust & psychological safety**
- **Open** communication
- Shared **responsibility**

High-performing teams are:
structured
AND flexible

Typical Problems:

- Unclear goals
- Role confusion
- Lack of trust
- Poor communication
- Cultural misunderstandings

Many problems come from:
hidden **assumptions** (Schein)
lack of **cultural sensitivity**

Team Diagnostics – How to Identify Real Problems

*Most team problems are **symptoms** ... **not** the **real** cause.*

→ Good leaders **diagnose** before they **act**.

How to Analyse a Team [Step-by-step]

- What is the **goal**?
- Are **roles** clear?
- How are **decisions** made?
- How do people **communicate**?
- Where does **conflict** come **from**?

Tools: Connect to Models

- **GRPI-based** thinking → Goals and Roles
- **Tuckman** → What **stage** is the team in?
- **Belbin** → Are **roles** balanced?
- **Cohesion** → Is the team **aligned**?
- **Schein** (Culture) → Are **hidden assumptions** causing issues?

Scenario:

*“A team keeps **missing deadlines** and **blaming each other**”*

Wrong diagnosis: (jump into Interpersonal)

*“They **do not** get along”*

Correct diagnosis:

- Goals **unclear**
- Roles **overlapping**
- **No defined** process

Fix structure → Conflict disappears

Great teams **do not eliminate** problems,
they **diagnose** them **correctly**.

Diagnosing Individual Performance: Skill vs Will



Not all performance problems are the **same**

They can be caused by:

- Lack of **skill (ability)**
- Lack of **will (motivation)**

	High Will	Low Will
High Skill	High Performer	Disengaged
Low Skill	Learner	Critical Case

Diagnosing Individual Performance: Skill vs Will, cont.

Meaning of each quadrant

	High Will	Low Will
High Skill	High Performer	Disengaged
Low Skill	Learner	Critical Case

High Skill – High Will  → *Ideal performer*

- Motivated
- Competent
- Reliable

→ Action:

- give autonomy
- challenge them

Low Skill – High Will → *Learner*

- Motivated
- Needs guidance

→ Action:

- provide training
- coaching

“Action are mostly by leader”

Diagnosing Individual Performance: Skill vs Will, cont.

Meaning of each quadrant

	High Will	Low Will
High Skill	High Performer	Disengaged
Low Skill	Learner	Critical Case

High Skill – Low Will ⚠️ → *Disengaged expert*

- Capable
- Not motivated

→ Action:

- identify cause (boredom? lack of recognition?)
- re-engage

Low Skill – Low Will ❌ → *Critical case*

- Not capable
- Not motivated

→ Action:

- **strong support OR role change**

“Action are mostly by leader”

Why it matters?

→ Paradigm Shift !

Shall improve the **diagnostic thinking** :

Before: "This person is the problem"

After: "Is this a **skill** issue or a **motivation** issue?"

Team Diagnostics Task [15-20 min]



If you do not have a team in mind →
use the **three use cases** uploaded to the Teams
channel

Think of a **team** you know, Run the Diagnostics:

- What is a REAL problem using **GRPI** ?
- **Cohesion and Performance?**
- Team **Roles (Belbin)?**
- Team **Development Stage (Tuckman)?**
- **Root Cause** Analysis?

On teams Channel, You can find
BINT24-IKHT-TeamsDiagnosticTool.pdf
"Use this to analyse and improve any team"

What looked like a **people** problem ... but was **actually** a structure problem?

Final insights:

Strong teams are **not** teams **without** problems.

Strong teams are teams that can **diagnose** **problems** correctly and
respond in a **structured** way.



Any Questions ?